

Strobe and beacon flash timing

The wing strobes flash the double flash of the real Airbus LED strobes, and the A380X beacons flash halfway between the strobes

Aircraft	A32NX and A380X
Where to find it	Exterior lights: overhead EXT LT panel, STROBE and BEACON switches; seen from the outside view
Branch	core/lights , based on master (FlyByWire master 255546cb0 merged in); independent.
Status	Checked in the sim by the user at night on both aircraft: OK (2026-10-02).
Pictures	No pictures: a flash timing does not show on a still picture.

1. Strobe double flash and beacon phase

Aircraft:	A32NX and A380X		Where:	EXT LT panel: STROBE ON, BEACON ON; outside view		Status:	Checked in the sim by the user at night on both aircraft ("both look right", 2026-10-02).
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What it is for

The FCOM gives no flash rates (A320 DSC-33-20-20, A380 DSC-33-30-20); the A380 FCOM only says that the strobes and the beacons alternate. The timing of the real lights comes from the Collins LED light data: a wing strobe double flash of 50 ms on, 60 ms off, 50 ms on, about 60 times a minute, the beacons flashing between the strobes. The FBW effects had a 50 ms gap (A32NX) and a 150 ms gap (A380X) in the double flash, and the A380X beacons flashed too close to the strobes.

What changed

Light	Before	Now
A32NX wing strobes	double flash 50-50-50 ms	double flash 50-60-50 ms , 60 per minute (unchanged rate)
A380X wing strobes	double flash 50-150-50 ms	double flash 50-60-50 ms , 45 per minute (unchanged rate)
A380X beacons	at +0.5 s in a 1.33 s cycle	at +0.67 s : exactly halfway between two strobe flashes
A32NX beacon, tail strobe	-	unchanged (beacon already halfway, at +0.5 s in a 1 s cycle)

Limitations and why

Limitation	Why	What to do
The A380X keeps its 45 flashes per minute.	There is no A380 source for the rate; 45 per minute is inside the Collins LED range (45 +/- 2).	-
A full MSFS restart is needed after an update.	The effect files (.fx) are loaded at sim start.	Restart the sim after installing.

How to use

1. Nothing to set: switch the **STROBE** and **BEACON** lights ON on the overhead EXT LT panel as usual.

How to test

#	Do this	Expected result
1	A32NX at night (or dusk), on the ground. Switch STROBE ON and BEACON ON . Go to an outside view that shows a wing tip and the fuselage.	Each wing strobe gives a crisp double flash (two short flashes very close together) about once a second.

2	Watch the beacon and the strobes together.	The beacon flashes halfway between two strobe double flashes: strobe, beacon, strobe, beacon, evenly spaced.
3	Repeat with the A380X.	Same crisp double flash of the wing strobes, a little slower (45 per minute); the beacons (top and belly) flash exactly halfway between the strobes, not right after them.